

Linux tee Command – Notes

1 What is tee Command?

The **tee command** reads input from **standard input (stdin)** and **writes it to both**:

- **Standard output (terminal)**
- **One or more files**

 It works like a **T-junction pipe** — output goes in two directions.

2 Why is tee Used?

- To **view command output on the terminal**
- **AND simultaneously save it to a file**
- Useful in **logging, debugging, and monitoring**

3 Basic Syntax

```
command | tee filename  
OR  
tee filename
```

4 Working Principle

- tee **does not generate output by itself**
- It **receives input** from another command or keyboard
- Then **duplicates the output**

 Default behavior:

 **Overwrites** the file

5 Common Examples

◆ Example 1: Display + Save Output

```
ls | tee output.txt
```

- ✓ Shows directory listing on terminal
- ✓ Saves it into output.txt

◆ Example 2: Take Input from Keyboard

```
tee file.txt
```

Type content → press Ctrl + D to save.

◆ Example 3: Append Instead of Overwrite

```
ls | tee -a output.txt
```

 **-a → append mode**

◆ Example 4: Write to Multiple Files

```
ls | tee file1.txt file2.txt
```

- ✓ Same output written to both files

6 Important Options

Option	Meaning
-a	Append output to file
-i	Ignore interrupt signals (Ctrl+C)
--help	Display help
--version	Show version info

7 tee with sudo (Important Concept)

Sometimes you get **permission denied** like:

```
echo "data" > /root/file.txt ❌
```

Solution using tee:

```
echo "data" | sudo tee /root/file.txt
```

✓ Works because tee runs with **sudo privileges**

8 Difference: > vs tee

Feature	>	tee
Show output on terminal	❌	✓
Save output to file	✓	✓
Write to multiple files	❌	✓
Works well with sudo	❌	✓